

The Glorious Secret Essence: Ascertainment of the Real

Śrīguhyagarbhatattvaviniścaya · Toh 832 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་གསང་བའ་སྒྲིབ་དྲིལ་ལོ་ཉེ་རྣམ་པར་ངམ་པ

Toh 832 in the Kangyur is the *Glorious Secret Essence Tantra Ascertaining the Real* (Sanskrit: *Śrīguhyagarbhatattvaviniścaya*; Tibetan: *dPal gsang ba'i snying po de kho na nyid rnam par nges pa*), one of the most celebrated and influential tantras of the Nyingma tradition, belonging to the class of Mahāyoga tantras. It opens with homage to the Blessed One Samantabhadra, invoking the primordial buddha as the source of the teaching, and proceeds to set the scene in which the Tathāgata expounds the profound and secret nature of reality. The text concerns the ultimate nature of mind and phenomena as inseparable from the enlightened mandala, presenting the esoteric view, symbolism, and practice associated with the tantric path to buddhahood. As a foundational scripture for the Nyingma school's exposition of the Great Perfection and tantric ritual, it holds a central place among the tantra collections of the Kangyur.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.